I can not but think that the arrival of the mission in this country[54] will enable me to arrange my affairs in some advantageous manner. I could not get leave to go to England and am nailed down here until the arrival of the mission. If I can get my affairs put in order I hope that my knowledge of the Persian and Turkish languages would enable me to earn my living somehow or somewhere in these countries. Many Englishmen know Persian, as it is the written language of a great part of India they are obliged to learn it. In Persia, Afghanistan and parts of Tartary and India, Persian is almost the only written language altho many others are talked. The knowledge of Turkish is much more rare and I have know[n] many Englishmen who have passed between twenty and thirty years of their lives in Turkey without learning the language. This language (Turkish) is perhaps talked over a larger portion of the globe than any other. From the frontiers of Hungary to the northern provinces of China, Turkish in various dialects, but all resembling one another so as to be understood by a man who knows one well, is the language talked. Arabic is I should think the next in extent of use.

England has gained a great name in the East by our achievements before Acre;[55] no one thought that fortress which caused Napoleon his first defeat and stood a seven months siege when attacked by Ibrahim Pasha's army would after its fortifications had been strengthened by the Pasha be taken in three hours by our ships. I am very glad that Ibrahim Pasha has been driven out of Syria. A more cruel and ruthless tyrant I do not think exists at the present day. When he evacuated Damascus he was obliged to leave behind about eight hundred sick in the hospitals these were all poisoned previous to the departure of the army and died in about three hours. On the road between Damascus and Aleppo any soldier who from fatigue could not keep up with the army was shot. In the villages in Syria almost all the men between the ages of fifteen and forty five have maimed themselves to prevent their being pressed to serve as soldiers. Some have their front teeth drawn to incapacitate them from biting cartridges. Others cut off the first and second joints of the first and second fingers of the right hand to prevent their being able to draw a trigger and some prefer having the right eye taken out. How horrible must be the oppression where men are willing to maim themselves rather than be obliged to serve as soldiers.

Persia is pretty quiet; there are some disturbances in the south, that is about Kerman but as an army has been sent there I should think they would be soon quelled. The Persian Princes who were at Baghdad gave a pretence to the turbu-

[54] The return of the English diplomatic mission, after the settlement of the dispute between the Shah and the English ambassador.

[55] This feat saved the Turkish Sultan from Ibrahim Pasha, his insurgent Egyptian governor, but left Egypt practically independent of the Porte.

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